



Anticipated Judge Q&A — with prepared responses

Accessibility as a Service (AaaS) · Team SUBARNAREKHA · Smart Odisha Hackathon '25, Jajpur

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Likely questions from the evaluation panel, with concise, defensible answers. The bold line in each answer is the point to land.

DIFFERENTIATION

Q1. Isn't this just another accessibility overlay (accessiBe / UserWay)?

Overlays are site-owner products: English-centric, cloud-based, proprietary, and widely criticised for falsely claiming a script makes a site “compliant.” We are the opposite on every count. **AaaS is user-controlled (a browser extension that works on any site), Indian-language-first, on-device, open-source, and honest — an assistive layer plus an API toolkit, not a compliance band-aid.**

Q2. Why not just use Google Translate plus a normal screen reader?

A blind Odia-speaking farmer will not stitch together three separate tools. AaaS is one button that reads aloud, translates and fills forms by voice — in Odia — on any page, including the many that mainstream screen readers handle poorly because they are built English-first. **We package fragmented capabilities into one accessible, Indian-language experience.**

Q3. Why not simply use Bhashini, the Government of India's language platform?

Bhashini is an excellent translation / ASR backend — and we are complementary, not competing. AaaS is the accessibility delivery layer (widget, cross-site extension, screen-reader, exam mode, dyslexia rendering) on top of it. **Our translation engine is pluggable — we can run on Bhashini, AI4Bharat IndicTrans2, or fully on-device — so we ride India's own rails, not against them.**

Q4. What stops Google or Microsoft from simply building this?

Nothing — but they build horizontal, English-first products, not Odia-first public infrastructure that a state can audit and self-host. **Our moat is focus, openness and sovereignty: an open, Indian-language accessibility stack the government owns rather than rents.**

TECHNICAL

Q5. How accurate is the Odia voice and the translation, and what about errors?

The voice is Meta's MMS-TTS (a VITS model; Odia is a first-class supported language) and translation is Indic-tuned (AI4Bharat IndicTrans2). This is assistive output, not legal text — and the user always retains the original on screen. **A slightly imperfect Odia reading is incomparably better than an English page the citizen cannot use at all.**

Q6. How does it work on sites that don't cooperate, or that block scripts via CSP?

The browser extension injects independently of the website, and the AI runs on-device in a sandboxed WebAssembly worker, so it is not blocked by the page's Content-Security-Policy. **We demonstrated it working live on Wikipedia — one of the strictest-CSP sites on the web.**

Q7. Is on-device AI fast enough on a low-end laptop?

The first use loads the model (a few seconds, shown as a clear status), after which it is cached and responsive, and results are cached across page reloads. If a device is too weak, the very same engines run on the gateway as a fallback. **Same voice — two places to run it.**

Q8. The extension injects into every website — isn't that a security and privacy risk?

It requests minimal permissions, renders its UI inside an isolated Shadow DOM that cannot read the host page's data, and **processes voice and text on-device — nothing is sent to a server.** Because it is open-source, any security team (including the government's) can audit exactly what it does.

TRUST & COMPLIANCE

Q9. Does installing this make a website WCAG- or legally compliant?

No — and we deliberately do not claim that (that false promise is precisely why overlays face lawsuits). We help institutions meet the RPwD Act 2016, GIGW 3.0 and WCAG 2.1, and we log WCAG results as evidence — but genuine compliance is built with our API, never faked with a script.

Q10. Where does citizen data go? (DPDP Act 2023)

For the extension, voice and page text stay on the device. For the gateway, processing is in-country and self-hostable. **No citizen data leaves the country or touches a foreign cloud — DPDP Act 2023 by design.**

ADOPTION & SUSTAINABILITY

Q11. It is open-source — how do you sustain it?

An open core (free for institutions to deploy, as a public good), sustained through deployment and integration support, hosting, custom language and voice packs, and government / CSR grants. **The goal is public infrastructure, like UPI — adoption first, sustainability through the services around it.**

Q12. How would a government actually adopt this?

Begin with a single department or university portal as a pilot — no rebuild needed, as it works on the existing site. Prove usage and WCAG evidence, then scale state-wide. **Our ask is exactly that: give us one site.**

ROADMAP & HONESTY

Q13. Is the sign-language avatar working today?

We are upfront: **it is our flagship next milestone, currently in development** — text → Indian Sign Language gloss → 3D avatar, built on the official ISLRTC ISL dictionary. We present the vision because no competitor even attempts sign language.

Q14. What did you actually build, versus use off the shelf?

We stand openly on open models — Meta MMS-TTS, OpenAI Whisper, AI4Bharat IndicTrans2. **What we built is the platform: the multi-tenant API gateway, the drop-in widget, the cross-site browser extension, the on-device WebAssembly pipeline, the accessible exam module, and the admin dashboard** — turning open models into deployable public accessibility infrastructure.

Internal prep note (not for the slides): Translation engine: the deck presents AI4Bharat IndicTrans2; the live demo currently runs on Google Translate for speed and coverage. If asked directly, the honest line is — “the engine is pluggable; the demo uses Google for reliability, production targets IndicTrans2 / Bhashini for sovereignty.” Never present the demo as IndicTrans2.